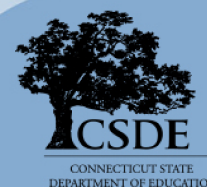


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



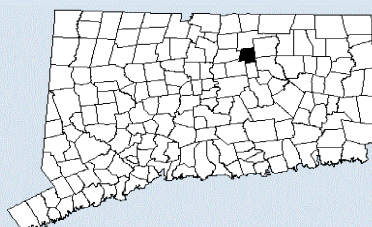
Vernon School District

Dr. Joseph Macary, Superintendent • 860-870-6000 • www.vernonschools.com/

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	11
Enrollment	3,050
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$17,007
Total Expenditures ¹	\$58,418,301

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.4
Male	1,537	50.4	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	213	7.0	5.2
Black or African American	318	10.4	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	649	21.3	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	224	7.3	4.0
White	1,640	53.8	49.9
English Learners	118	3.9	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,669	54.7	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	551	18.1	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	26	1.6
Male	266	18.0	52	3.2
Black or African American	77	25.6	12	3.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	149	23.9	25	3.5
White	216	13.5	36	2.1
English Learners	20	17.2	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	396	26.5	63	3.4
Students with Disabilities	174	30.4	28	4.1
District	518	17.5	78	2.4
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 135

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Vernon School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	231.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	15.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	39.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	82.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	7.3
School Level	14.2
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.0
Support Staff	8.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	11.8
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	26.8
School Nurses	8.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	168.2

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	2	0.6	1.3
Black or African American	7	2.1	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	12	3.6	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	311	93.7	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	6.9	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	19	95.0	12	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	34	85.0	18	81.8
White	136	97.8	127	91.4
English Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	83	93.3	59	79.7
Students with Disabilities	39	90.7	28	62.2
District	212	95.5	173	89.6
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	35	40.7
Emotional Disturbance	17	36.2
Intellectual Disability	7	23.3
Learning Disability	133	65.8
Other Health Impairment	60	60.6
Other Disabilities	6	*
Speech/Language Impairment	33	91.7
District	291	56.3
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Vernon School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	93	2.9	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	47	1.5	1.1
Intellectual Disability	31	1.0	0.5
Learning Disability	202	6.3	5.8
Other Health Impairment	99	3.1	3.3
Other Disabilities	35	1.1	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	47	1.5	1.9
All Disabilities	554	17.4	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	42	7.6	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	16	2.9	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$31,572,532	\$9,191	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$7,157,107	\$2,284	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$3,020,652	\$964	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$2,557,350	\$816	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$3,254,844	\$1,039	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$1,284,590	\$410	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$6,641,415	\$2,119	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$2,382,280	\$826	\$1,159
Food services	\$76,992	\$25	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$470,538	\$150	\$151
Total	\$58,418,301	\$17,007	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$2,930,075	21.9	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,170,066	16.2	11.1
Other Salaries	\$2,973,895	22.2	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$162,937	1.2	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$319,846	2.4	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$3,400,421	25.4	22.5
Supplies	\$16,970	0.1	0.5
Property Services	\$8,000	0.1	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,425,138	10.6	7.2
Equipment	\$1,681	0.0	0.2
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$13,409,029	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		23.0	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	59.7
State	36.4
Federal	3.0
Tuition & Other	0.9

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Vernon School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Vernon School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	29	75.9
Hispanic or Latino of any race	29	69.0
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	117	72.6
Students with Disabilities	30	46.7
District	203	82.3
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	87.4	53	25.7
Male	81.3	50	23.9
Black or African American	85.7	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	79.0	*	*
White	85.6	87	31.3
English Learners	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	77.9	17	10.4
Students with Disabilities	60.2	*	*
District	84.3	103	24.8
State	85.0		36.0

³ College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴ Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	71.3	86.5
Male	59.3	73.2
Black or African American	54.5	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	67.9	80.4
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	52.3	82.0
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	64.9	80.8
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Vernon School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	17.5%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	25.3%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	92.8%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	24.8%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		83.1%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		82.3%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		70.9%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		64.9%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		59.4%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	93.9%	70.9%	23.0%	9.8%	Y

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Vernon School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Vernon Public Schools believes that the educational programs and services available in the district provide opportunities for the academic, social, and emotional growth of our student population. Our district improvement plan and aligned school improvement plans along with parent & community outreach activities highlight our efforts to strengthen student learning outcomes. The District Attendance Team meets monthly to review district data and discuss strategies to support and partner with families. Schools work collaboratively with families to identify the root cause of absences, problem solve and identify proactive strategies to support the student. A mentor program has been established at Vernon Center Middle School and Rockville High School to support at-risk students for chronic absenteeism. School staff, including Family Engagement Coordinators have connected families to community resources such as Cornerstone Foundation, Vernon Social Services, Vernon Youth Services, Hockanum Valley Community Council (HVCC), YMCA, ECHN Family Resource Center and the Rockville Public Library. Home school communication was a priority for the 20-21 school year. Parent Square was implemented at the high school level as a communication tool with families. Select Administrative Council meetings dedicated to professional learning on family engagement. The District Climate and Engagement Team focused its professional learning on equity and diversity. These efforts are being implemented to help build equitable practices within the district. Laugh and Learn is an opportunity for caregivers and children ages 1-5 to participate in fun and interactive learning activities. The program was held in a virtual format for the 20-21 school year allowing families to still connect and provide learning experiences for their children. The district provides ongoing parent workshops through Peace at Home through live and recorded webinar sessions. The sessions focus on the social, emotional and behavioral well-being of children. The Ready Set School Fair (held virtually this year) is an opportunity for families of children ages 2-5 to learn of resources within the community and students entering kindergarten for the fall of 2021 received an activity bag of learning materials.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Vernon is a diverse community with five elementary schools, one middle school and one high school. Rockville High School recruits students for Advanced Placement courses, Early College Experience (ECE) courses, and other courses that may garner college credit prior to graduation. All grade 10 and 11 students take the PSAT. A YES team (Youth Empowerment Squad) has been established to provide student voice in addressing the needs of all students within our schools. All students in grades K - 8 engage in the social awareness curriculum which teaches social skills. Students have alternative educational options such as Magnet Schools, Open Choice and Charter Schools. ESL programs are offered at several schools. Our website offers many family-friendly functions including a translation feature for non-English speaking families. The district also utilizes a phone translation and in-person translation services as needed. Vernon has provided extensive professional learning in curriculum writing and implementation ensuring that all students have access to the same rigorous curriculum and resources. Several staff in the district participated in professional opportunities this year to develop a better understanding of diversity and equity. Families without internet access were connected to free internet options to ensure connectivity to school. Families have been connected to community resources (Cornerstone Foundation and HVCC) to ensure families have access to food and other basic needs. VPS works closely with town departments to ensure that families have access to resources such as energy assistance and programming for children.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Vernon School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Vernon Public School district has a common curriculum guaranteed for every student. All curriculum resources are located on the secure staff portal ensuring equitable access among all classrooms. The elementary principals collaboratively plan their budgets to ensure equity among resources. All initiatives are systemic in Vernon ensuring that each student, K - 12, will have access to the same rigorous curriculum. Each student shall be given equitable access to education and student technology resources are available at all schools at all grade levels. Community members have access to any and all communication media, newsletters, periodicals, advisory services and representation in actions affecting education in general and the public schools in particular. All Schools have a leadership team which provides input to the principal and the building leadership team on the school improvement plan and other initiatives in the school. Schools provide portal access to parents and families for the ASPEN Student Information System and sponsor monthly newsletters to recognize students and families. All families have access to the Fam